

EXTREME

PRIVACY:

WHAT

IT

TAKES

TO

DISAPPEAR

**EXTREME PRIVACY:
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FIFTH EDITION

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The left-page and right-page offset margins were intentionally included within this digital edition instead of centered margins throughout. This allows printing and binding if desired.

The technology referenced in this book was edited and verified by a professional team for accuracy. Exact tutorials in reference to websites, software, and hardware configurations change rapidly. All tutorials in this book were confirmed accurate as of October 1, 2024. Readers may find slight discrepancies within the methods as technology changes.

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FIFTH EDITION PREFACE

The previous (fourth) edition of this book was originally published in early 2022. In 2023, we began publishing digital supplemental updates via PDF files, which allowed us to keep the technical aspects current. This provided a longer shelf-life for the non-technical "guts" of the book, but three years is an eternity in this space. In late 2024, we decided to update the overall work, which is what you have here. This is not a simple facelift, as we have drastically changed the flow, content, and goals for this edition, as follows.

First, I no longer present strategies which I believe are not optimal. In the previous edition, I delivered my recommendations, and then followed with alternative options for those who did not want to go the extreme route. With this book, I spend more time on the ideal solutions while trying to avoid compromises.

Second, I restructured chapters into sections, and isolated specific tasks for easier execution. In the previous edition, I presented huge chapters which covered a lot of ground. As one example, the mobile devices chapter was 77 pages and covered everything from selection and configuration of a mobile device all the way through DNS, VoIP options, and advanced applications. People were simply overwhelmed with the amount of information. In this book, I isolate each individual topic into its own "task". This allows readers to focus on one specific step, and may offer a feeling of accomplishment once the task is complete. In this example, the mobile devices section is now split into dozens of bite-size tasks which can each easily be completed in order.

Third, I offer a more chronological program. During a consult in late 2023, a client shared that she had read the previous edition twice, but was still very confused about the order of events ideal for her. Her voice was in my head while I wrote this updated work. In this edition, I have reorganized all tasks to flow in the most ideal order for most readers. This eliminates some of the confusion about finishing one task before starting another, or the need to wait for a service to be activated before proceeding with the next step. Every task in this guide is independent of the next, as long as they are followed in order.

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I have poured every tactic, method, and experience I have into this new edition. Please approach the content slowly and methodically. There is a lot to digest. This book was accurate as of August 2024. **If, or more likely when, you find techniques which no longer work, use the overall lessons here to modify your own strategies.** Once you develop an understanding of the content, you will be ready to adapt. I hope you find something valuable here which will protect you from a growing number of threats. I am truly excited to introduce a new level of privacy and security.